

Post-Retreat Discussion Notes

Key themes emerging from conversations since the PAC retreat.

1. Designated Points of Contact

Need: Designated point of contact for both Co-pilot and AI Builder.

- People need to know where to go with questions
 - Contact must be sufficiently familiar with the tools to help get answers
 - Currently unclear who owns these relationships
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2. AI Technical Users Group

Need: Launch an AI Technical Users Group.

There are now enough technically proficient AI users to form a critical mass: - Barry Lambert - Paul Quinnell - Taylor Hutyra - Justin Carrell - Kade Gibson - Others

Purpose: Each person has pieces of a puzzle but not the whole picture. The group helps them put their pieces together.

Note: This is essentially what the AI Council's Infrastructure & Implementation subgroup was intended to be. That group lacked sufficient knowledge resources and membership at the time. The new Users Group could effectively *become* that subgroup now that we have the right people.

3. Re-evaluate AI Council Structure

Need: Review AI Council's composition, membership, and structure.

Current state: - Launched without upper leadership representation - Zach and I are the highest-ranking members

Changes to consider: - Include people like Barry Lambert who are deeply invested and have resources/staff to contribute - Broader leadership engagement

4. AI Enablement Team

Need: Consider forming a dedicated AI Enablement Team.

Current state: - Taylor, Justin, and I are the closest thing to a "help people build AI solutions" function - This is not our intended job - We typically don't have capacity to take on many projects

An enablement team would formalize this support role.

5. Texas AI Compute Cooperative Initiative (TAICCI)

Date: July 28, 2026 (day after PAC retreat)

Texas A&M joined Phase 1 of TAICCI.

Significance: If successful, this becomes foundational infrastructure for: - Teaching - Research

A major piece of the University's long-term AI journey.

6. Enterprise AI Platform Evaluation

In progress: Approaching OpenAI, Google, and Anthropic for quotes on secure AI services with M365 integration.

Goal is to establish enterprise-grade AI infrastructure that connects into existing Microsoft environment.

7. Budget Reallocation for AI Strategy

Action taken: Redirected \$43,000 earmarked for Gartner contract renewal.

- Gartner renewal process is delayed
 - Funds reallocated to University AI strategy
 - Will support:
 - Internal AI development within Strategic Insights
 - Premises/infrastructure enabling others (e.g., Lambert) to develop solutions in a secure environment
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8. AI Curriculum Integration (Academic Affairs)

Lead: Denise Martinez (identified by Barry Lambert)

Initiative to integrate AI into the University curriculum. Groundwork underway between Denise and myself.

Note: This initiative is the natural home for Dr. Hurley's idea for outward-facing AI certification programs.

Summary: Emerging Roadmap Milestones

Priority	Action
1	Designate Co-pilot & AI Builder points of contact
2	Launch AI Technical Users Group
3	Restructure AI Council (membership, leadership)
4	Evaluate need for AI Enablement Team
5	TAICCI Phase 1 participation (foundational compute infrastructure)
6	Secure enterprise AI platform (OpenAI / Google / Anthropic quotes)
7	Deploy \$43K toward AI development infrastructure
8	AI curriculum integration (Denise Martinez / Academic Affairs)